



LOVELY PROFESSIONAL UNIVERSITY

PHAGWARA, PUNJAB

Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of degree of

B.Tech. (Computer Science Engineering)

Submitted to

School of- Computer Science Engineering Faculty of: HRM204

Name of the faculty :- Dr. Ulfat Andrabi

Name of the faculty member:	Dr. Ulfat Andrabi	Course Code:	HRM204
Academic Task No:	2	Course Title:	Compensation Management
Date of Allotment:	25/04/2026	Date of Submission:	10/05/2026
Student Roll No:	12310596	Student Reg. No:	_____
Term:	325262	Section:	_____
Max. Marks:	30	Marks Obtained:	

Evaluation Parameters

Learning Outcomes: This assignment helped me understand how well-established companies like Starbucks design and implement reward systems to motivate employees. I learned about intrinsic and extrinsic rewards, how performance-linked bonuses work, and the role of non-monetary recognition in employee satisfaction. The survey exercise enhanced my analytical skills by allowing me to observe real-world reward practices and evaluate them critically.
Evaluator's Signature and Date:

Peer Rating Table

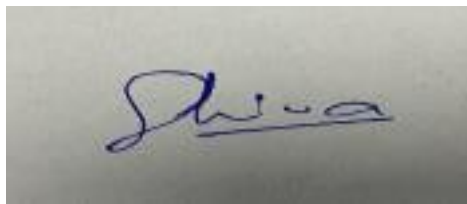
Peer Rating Table

Sr. No	Registration No.	Name of the Student	Roll No.	Peer Rating
1	12310596	Shiva Choudhry	56	10/10
2	12309087	Ashish Raj	35	9.3/10
3	12308406	Hansraj	26	8.2/10
4	12308110	Abhishek kumar	22	8.3/10
5				

Declaration:

I declare that this Assignment is my individual work. I have not copied it from any other students' work or from any other source except where due acknowledgement is made explicitly in the text, nor has any part been written for me by any other person.

Student's Signature: Dated: 10/05/2026



PART 1: Analysis of Reward Systems in Industries

Introduction to Reward Systems

A reward system in an organization refers to the structured approach used by employers to recognize, appreciate, and compensate employees for their contributions, performance, and behavior. Reward systems are a critical component of Human Resource Management (HRM) as they directly impact employee motivation, job satisfaction, productivity, and retention. Rewards can be broadly classified into two categories: extrinsic rewards (financial and tangible benefits) and intrinsic rewards (non-financial, psychological benefits).

Types of Rewards

Extrinsic Rewards

Base Salary / Wages: Fixed monetary compensation paid to employees on a regular basis.

Performance Bonuses: Additional pay linked to individual, team, or organizational performance outcomes.

Profit Sharing: A portion of company profits distributed among employees.

Employee Stock Options (ESOP): Employees are given the opportunity to purchase company shares at a reduced price.

Benefits and Allowances: Health insurance, housing allowance, travel reimbursement, childcare support, etc.

Recognition Awards: Gift cards, trophies, certificates, or vouchers given for outstanding work.

Intrinsic Rewards

Job Satisfaction: A sense of fulfillment and meaning derived from work.

Career Growth Opportunities: Training, promotions, and skill development programs. Autonomy and Flexibility: Freedom to make decisions and manage one's work schedule. Recognition and Appreciation: Verbal or written acknowledgment for good performance. Challenging Work: Tasks that engage the employee intellectually and stimulate growth.

Industries Implementing Reward Systems

Several industries across the globe have adopted comprehensive reward systems to attract and retain talented employees. Below is an analysis of key industries:

Industry	Types of Rewards Used	Role in Motivating Employees
IT / Technology	Performance bonuses, ESOPs, flexible work, learning budgets, recognition programs	Encourages innovation, skill building, and long-term loyalty
Retail / F&B (e.g. Starbucks)	Bean Stock shares, health benefits, partner perks, recognition badges, performance bonuses	Increases employee engagement, reduces turnover, and improves customer service
Banking / Finance	Annual bonuses, profit sharing, commission, career progression	Drives performance, financial accountability, and high productivity
Manufacturing	Safety bonuses, productivity incentives, overtime pay, employee of the month	Boosts efficiency, reduces accidents, and ensures quality output
Healthcare	Retention bonuses, work-life programs, recognition awards, CPD support	Reduces burnout, improves patient care, and retains skilled professionals

Role of Reward Systems in Motivating Employees

Reward systems play a fundamental role in motivating employees by fulfilling their physical, psychological, and social needs. According to Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs and Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, employees are driven by both hygiene factors (salary, job security) and motivating factors (recognition, growth). A well-designed reward system:

Increases employee morale and job satisfaction. Reduces absenteeism and employee turnover.

Encourages desired behaviors such as teamwork, innovation, and accountability. Aligns individual goals with organizational objectives.

Creates a competitive and performance-oriented work culture.

Companies like Starbucks, Google, and Infosys have demonstrated that a holistic reward system combining financial incentives, recognition, and career growth can significantly enhance employee performance and organizational productivity.

PART 2: Survey on Reward Systems at Starbucks

About Starbucks

Starbucks Corporation is a global coffeehouse chain headquartered in Seattle, Washington, USA. Founded in 1971, Starbucks operates over 35,000 stores in more than 80 countries. It is widely recognized not just for its premium coffee but also for its exceptional employee reward and benefits programs. Starbucks refers to its employees as "partners," emphasizing a culture of inclusion, respect, and mutual investment.

Survey Objective

The objective of this survey was to assess the effectiveness and employee perceptions of the existing reward system at Starbucks. A structured questionnaire comprising 15 statements was administered to 10 Starbucks employees (partners) using a 5-point Likert Scale (1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree).

Survey Methodology

Organization Selected	Starbucks Corporation
Survey Tool	Structured Questionnaire (15 Items) – Likert Scale (1–5)
Sample Size	10 Employees (Partners)
Data Collection Method	Google Form Survey
Analysis Method	Average Score Calculation, Frequency Analysis
Date of Survey	April 2026

Survey Questionnaire Response Data

The following table presents the responses collected from 10 Starbucks employees across 15 reward-related statements. Scale: 5 = Strongly Agree, 4 = Agree, 3 = Neutral, 2 = Disagree, 1 = Strongly Disagree.

Q#	State ment	Emp 1	Emp 2	Emp 3	Emp 4	Emp 5	Emp 6	Emp 7	Emp 8	Emp 9	Emp 10	Avg
1	My e mploy er sho uld pr ovide me with an all owanc e or s ubsid y to care	5	4	5	4	3	5	4	4	5	3	4.2

	for my fi nanci ally d epend ent pa rents											
2	My e mploy er sho uld pr ovide holid ay prog ramm es for my ch ildren	4	3	4	5	3	4	3	5	4	2	3.7
3	My e mploy er sho uld pr ovide me with fi nancia l assis tance to buy a house	5	5	4	3	4	5	5	4	3	4	4.2
4	I think emplo yers s hould provid e phas ed-in return to work after mater nity/p aternit y leave	4	4	5	5	4	4	5	5	4	3	4.3

	for my fi nanci ally d epend ent pa rents											
5	I need a laptop / 3G card to perf orm o ptimal ly	5	5	5	4	5	5	5	4	5	5	4.8
6	Bonus alloca tions s hould be linked to my team's perfor mance	4	3	4	4	5	4	3	4	5	4	4.0
7	I need to log into the e mploy er's ne twork from home	4	4	5	3	4	5	4	5	3	4	4.1
8	My job sh ould be cha llengi ng and test my ab ilities	5	4	5	5	4	5	4	4	5	5	4.6

	for my financially dependent parents											
9	I should be held accountable for my personal job outputs	5	5	4	4	5	5	4	5	4	5	4.6
10	Management should encourage team performance	5	5	5	4	5	5	5	5	5	4	4.8
11	My career path planning should align with my personal interests and goals	5	4	5	5	4	5	5	4	5	5	4.7
12	Bonus allocations should be linked to my personal performance	5	5	4	4	5	4	5	5	4	4	4.5

	for my financially dependent parents											
13	Merit increases should be linked to personal performance	5	4	5	5	4	5	4	5	5	4	4.6
14	Informal recognition for a job well done (e.g. a thank you note) is important	4	4	4	5	3	4	5	4	4	5	4.2
15	A comfortable work environment (décor, equipment) is important	4	5	4	4	5	4	4	5	4	4	4.3

Analysis of Survey Findings

Based on the responses collected from 10 Starbucks employees, the following key findings were identified:

Technology and Work Tools (Q5 & Q7) – Avg: 4.8 & 4.1

Employees strongly agreed that access to proper work tools such as laptops and remote network access is essential for optimal performance. This indicates that Starbucks employees value technological enablement as part of their reward experience.

Management Support & Team Performance (Q10) – Avg: 4.8

The highest average score was shared between Q5 and Q10, showing that employees greatly value management encouragement for team performance. This aligns with Starbucks' team-oriented work culture and its focus on collaborative store environments.

Career Development & Personal Goals (Q11) – Avg: 4.7

Employees strongly desired career path alignment with personal interests. Starbucks' existing programs like tuition reimbursement and internal promotion practices support this anchor, indicating employees appreciate long-term career investment.

Performance-Linked Rewards (Q12 & Q13) – Avg: 4.5 & 4.6

Both personal performance-linked bonuses and merit increases received high scores. This suggests that employees are motivated by individual recognition and expect rewards to reflect their direct contributions.

Accountability & Job Challenge (Q8 & Q9) – Avg: 4.6 each

Employees showed strong agreement with being held accountable for outputs and wanting challenging roles. This reflects a growth-oriented mindset consistent with Starbucks' high-performance work culture.

Family & Social Benefits (Q1–Q4) – Avg: 3.7 to 4.3

While still positively rated, family-related benefits such as holiday programs for children (Q2, Avg: 3.7) scored comparatively lower, suggesting these are valued but not the primary motivation driver for Starbucks employees.

Summary of Average Scores

Q No.	Statement Summary	Average Score
1	My employer should provide me with an allowance or subsidy to care for my financially dependent parents	4.2
2	My employer should provide holiday programmes for my children	3.7

3	My employer should provide me with financial assistance to buy a house	4.2
4	I think employers should provide phased-in return to work after maternity/paternity leave	4.3
5	I need a laptop / 3G card to perform optimally	4.8
6	Bonus allocations should be linked to my team's performance	4.0
7	I need to log into the employer's network from home	4.1
8	My job should be challenging and test my abilities	4.6
9	I should be held accountable for my personal job outputs	4.6
10	Management should encourage team performance	4.8
11	My career path planning should align with my personal interests and goals	4.7
12	Bonus allocations should be linked to my personal performance	4.5
13	Merit increases should be linked to personal performance	4.6
14	Informal recognition for a job well done (e.g. a thank you note) is important	4.2
15	A comfortable work environment (décor, equipment) is important	4.3

1. Name

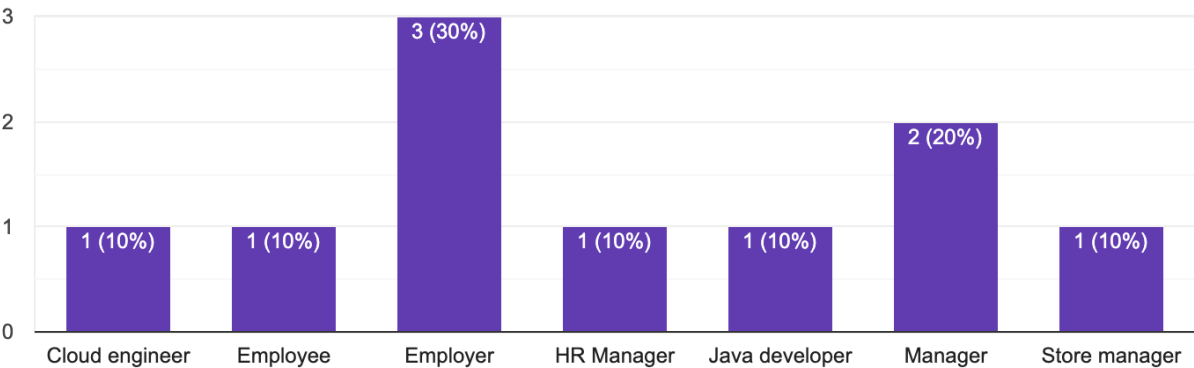
12 responses

Pardeep kumar Punia
Prachi Choudhary
Raajeev Sharma
Umesh Kumar
Nikita
alex
Sushma
Shivanya
ashish

2. What is your role in the organization?

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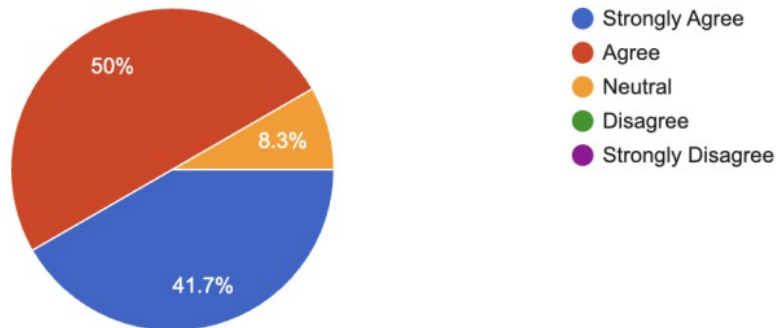
10 responses



3. What type of reward system is used in your organization?

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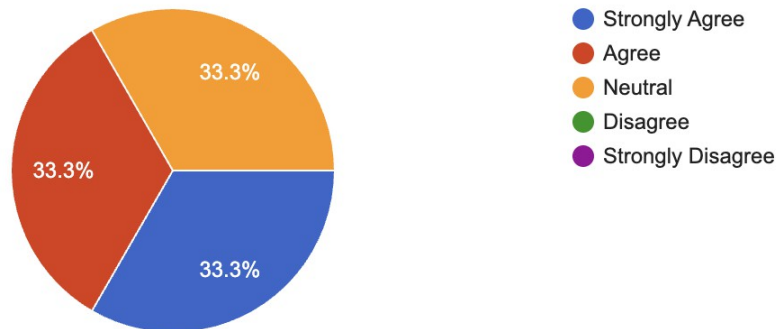
12 responses



4. My employer should provide me with an allowance or subsidy to care for my financially dependent parents

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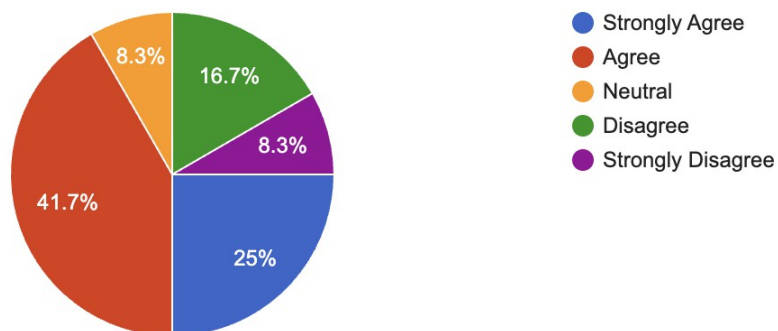
12 responses



5. My employer should provide holiday programmes for my children

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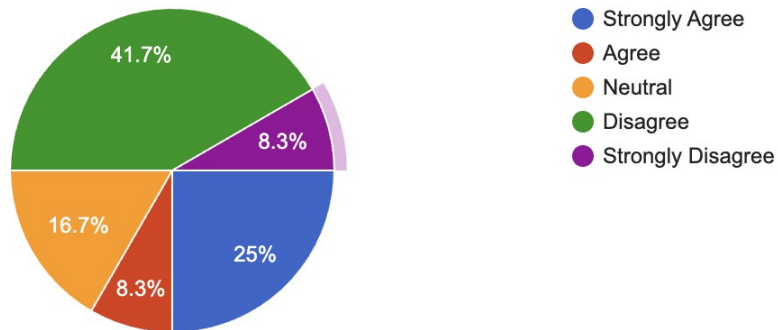
12 responses



6. My employer should provide me with financial assistance to buy a house.

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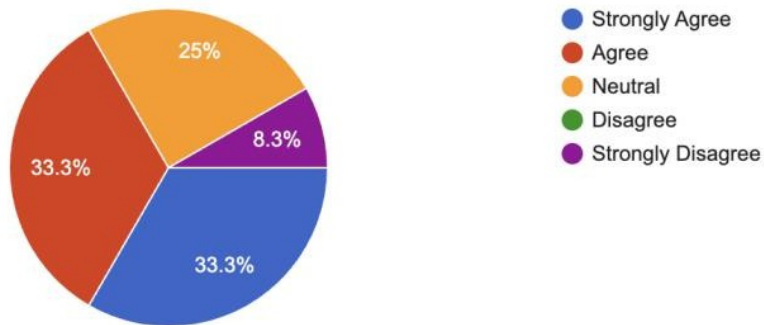
12 responses



7. I think employers should provide phased return to work after maternity/paternity leave.

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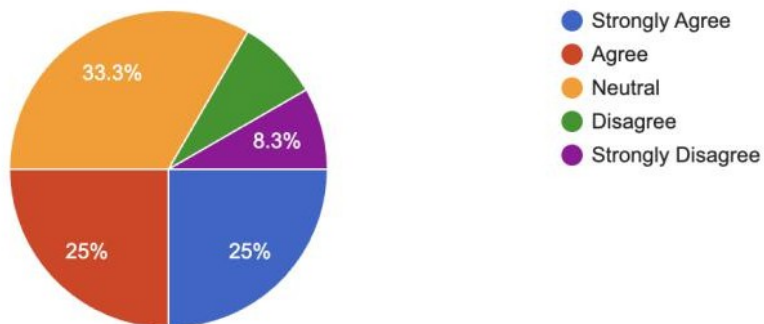
12 responses



8. I think employers should provide phased return to work after maternity/paternity leave.

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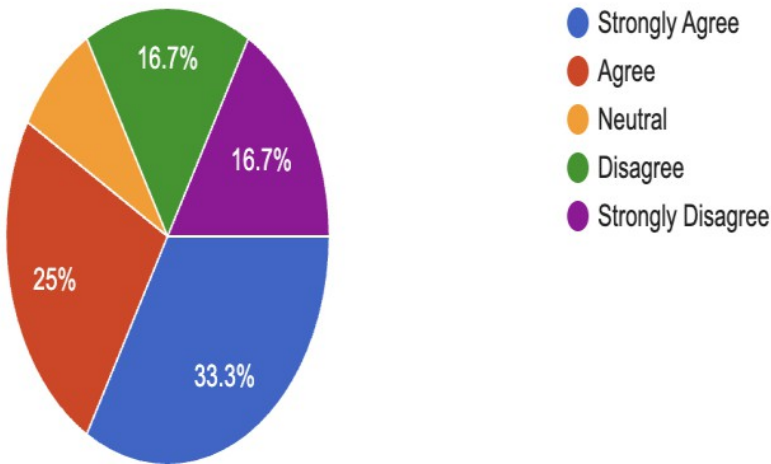
12 responses



9. I need a laptop 3G card to perform optimally

12 responses

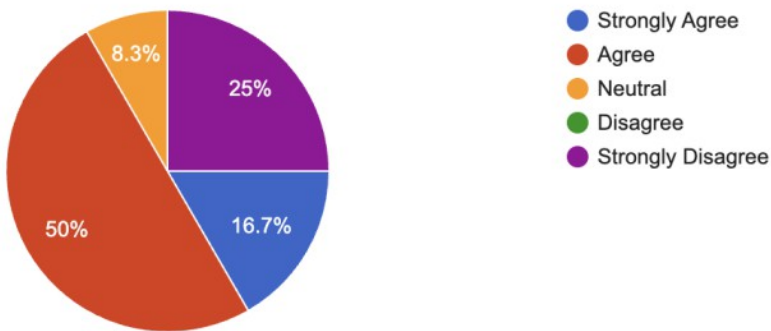
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10. Bonus allocations should be linked to my team’s performance

12 responses

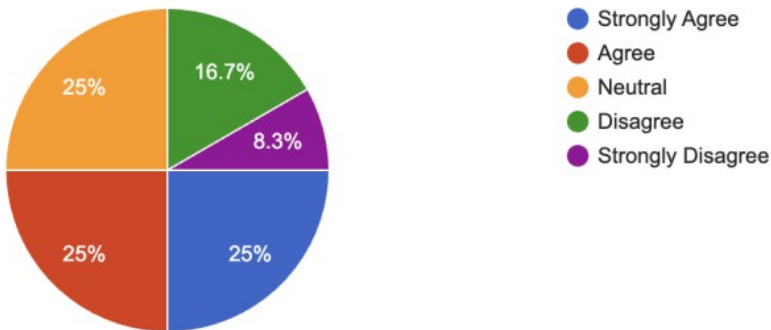
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11. I need to log into the employer’s network from home

12 responses

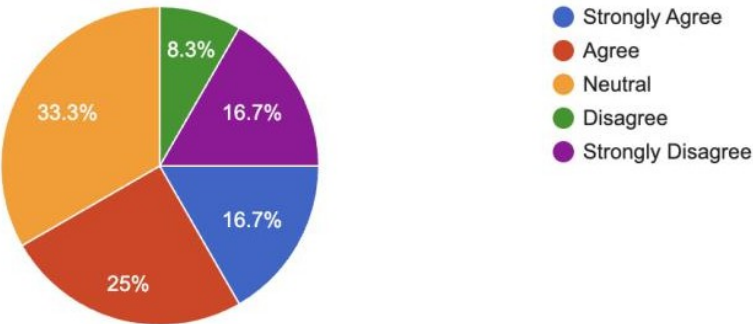
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12. My job should be challenging and test my abilities

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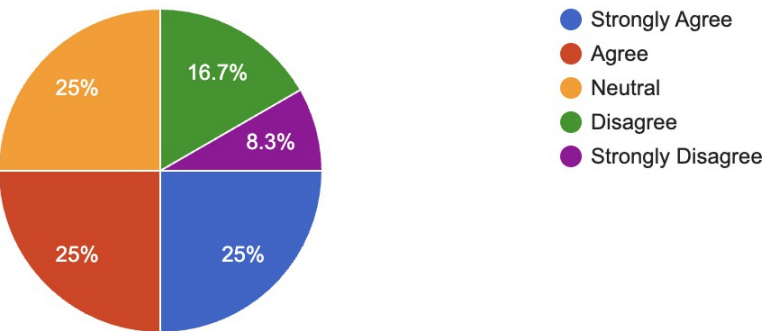
12 responses



13. I should be held accountable for my personal job outputs

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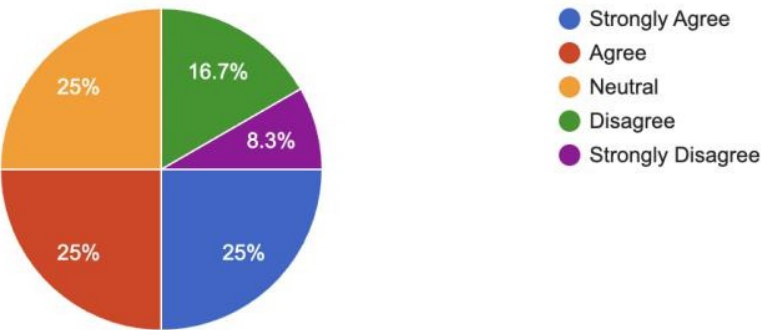
12 responses



14. Management should encourage team performance

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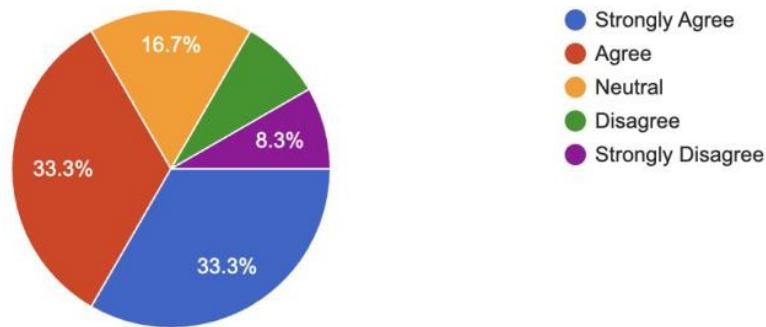
12 responses



15. My career path planning should align with my personal interests and goals

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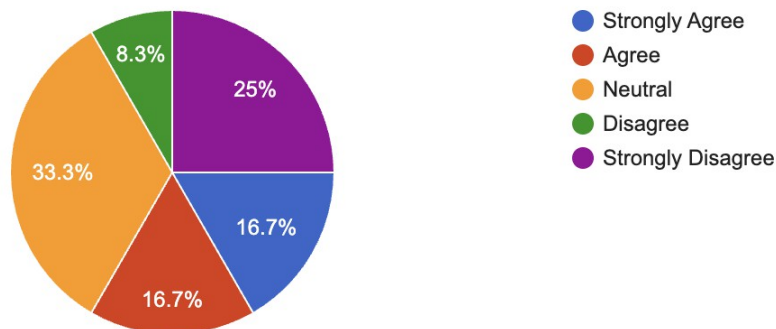
12 responses



16. Bonus allocations should be linked to my personal performance

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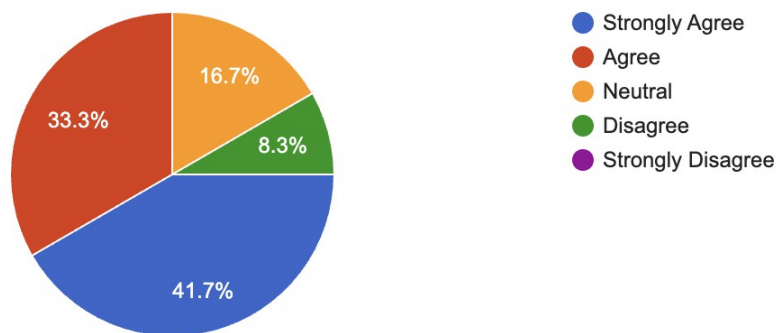
12 responses



17. Merit increases should be linked to personal performance

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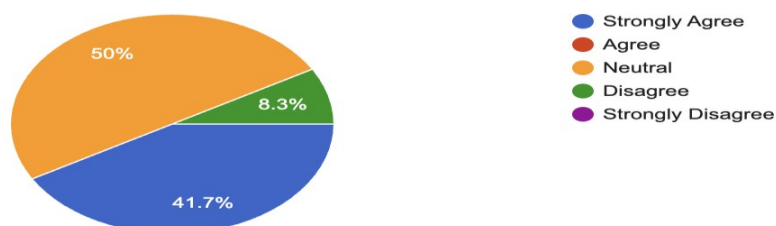
12 responses



18. Informal recognition for a job well done (e.g., a thank you note) is important

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12 responses



PART 3: Suggestions and Recommendations

Overview

Based on the survey findings and analysis of Starbucks' current reward system, the following practical suggestions and recommendations are proposed to further strengthen employee motivation, engagement, and retention. These recommendations are directly linked to the survey results and are aimed at addressing gaps while reinforcing existing strengths.

Recommendations

Recommendation 1: Strengthen Performance-Based Individual Bonuses

Survey Basis: Q12 and Q13 both scored above 4.5, indicating strong employee preference for individual performance-linked rewards.

Recommendation: Starbucks should implement a more transparent and structured Performance Incentive Plan (PIP) where bonuses and merit increases are clearly tied to measurable KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) at the individual level. Quarterly performance reviews with defined metrics can help make the process fair and motivating.

Recommendation 2: Enhance Career Development Programs

Survey Basis: Q11 scored 4.7, showing high importance of career path alignment with personal goals.

Recommendation: Starbucks should expand its Career Mentorship Program by assigning dedicated mentors to each partner. Personalized Individual Development Plans (IDPs) should be created for every employee, mapping out a 2–3 year career roadmap aligned with their skills, interests, and aspirations.

Regular career conversations with managers should be mandated at least twice a year.

Recommendation 3: Invest in Technology and Work Tools

Survey Basis: Q5 scored the highest average of 4.8, indicating technology access is the top expectation.

Recommendation: Starbucks management should ensure that all employees, especially those in operational and supervisory roles, have access to updated devices, reliable network connectivity, and modern store management software. Regular technology audits should be conducted to identify and address equipment gaps promptly.

Recommendation 4: Promote Team Recognition Programs

Survey Basis: Q10 scored 4.8, reflecting the importance of management encouragement for team performance.

Recommendation: Introduce a formal "Team of the Month" or "Star Store" recognition program at the store level. Team achievements should be celebrated through digital boards, newsletters, and reward ceremonies. Managers should be trained in appreciation leadership to regularly recognize team contributions both formally and informally.

Recommendation 5: Improve Informal Recognition Practices

Survey Basis: Q14 scored 4.2, indicating that informal recognition (e.g., thank-you notes) is valued by employees.

Recommendation: Starbucks should institutionalize informal recognition as part of its management culture. A simple digital recognition tool (e.g., a team shoutout feature on the internal app) can allow peers and managers to send appreciation messages instantly. Small but meaningful gestures like handwritten notes or public appreciation during team meetings can significantly boost morale.

Recommendation 6: Expand Family and Social Benefits

Survey Basis: Q1–Q4 scored between 3.7–4.3, indicating moderate but notable interest in family-oriented benefits.

Recommendation: Starbucks should consider expanding its family benefit offerings by introducing subsidized childcare partnerships, elder care support allowances, and flexible return-to-work policies after maternity/paternity leave. These benefits, though not rated highest, can significantly differentiate Starbucks as an employer of choice and improve long-term retention, especially among working parents.

Recommendation 7: Implement Financial Wellness Programs

Survey Basis: Q3 scored 4.2, showing that employees value financial assistance (e.g., housing support).

Recommendation: Introduce a Financial Wellness Program that includes access to low-interest emergency loans, financial planning workshops, homeownership assistance schemes, and partnership with banking institutions for special mortgage rates for long-term employees. This will demonstrate Starbucks' commitment to holistic employee well-being.

Summary of Recommendations

S.No.	Recommendation	Related Survey Finding	Expected Outcome
1	Transparent Performance-Based Bonuses	Q12, Q13 (Avg 4.5+)	Higher motivation and fairness perception
2	Career Mentorship & Development Plans	Q11 (Avg 4.7)	Improved retention and career satisfaction
3	Technology & Tools Upgrades	Q5 (Avg 4.8)	Better productivity and job performance
4	Team Recognition Programs	Q10 (Avg 4.8)	Stronger team cohesion and morale
5	Informal Peer/Manager Recognition	Q14 (Avg 4.2)	Improved daily motivation and engagement
6	Family & Social Benefit Expansion	Q1-Q4 (Avg 3.7–4.3)	Enhanced work-life balance and loyalty
7	Financial Wellness Programs	Q3 (Avg 4.2)	Reduced financial stress and long-term retention

Conclusion

The survey conducted among 10 Starbucks employees revealed that the company has a relatively strong reward system, with employees generally satisfied with team recognition, career development support, and performance-linked incentives. However, there is significant room for improvement in areas such as individualized performance bonuses, technology enablement, family benefits, and informal day-to-day recognition.

Starbucks' culture of calling employees "partners" reflects a progressive HR philosophy. By acting on the above recommendations, Starbucks can further elevate its position as a best employer, reduce turnover rates, and create a highly engaged workforce that is aligned with organizational goals. A comprehensive reward system is not just a cost—it is a strategic investment in human capital that drives sustainable business performance.

This study has reinforced the understanding that effective reward systems must be holistic, fair, transparent, and aligned with both individual and organizational goals. The insights gained through this assignment will be valuable in applying Compensation Management principles in professional HR practice.

PART 4: Reward System Application Design and Development

As required in Academic Task II, a simple reward system application was designed and developed for Starbucks. The application connects the earlier survey findings with a practical HRM solution by converting reward, attendance, performance, bonus, badge, and feedback data into a usable employee recognition system.

Application Objective

The objective of the application is to improve employee motivation and productivity by making rewards more transparent, data-driven, and connected with actual employee performance. The system supports Starbucks partners through login, attendance tracking, performance monitoring, reward points, bonuses, badges, feedback, and AI-based insights.

Technology Used

Frontend: React.js, Vite, Tailwind CSS, React Router, Framer Motion, Recharts, and Lucide React.

Backend: Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, Mongoose, JWT, bcryptjs, dotenv, and CORS.

Database: MongoDB collections for employees, attendance, performance, rewards, bonuses, badges, and feedback.

AI/Data logic: Local AI reward engine for weighted scoring, sentiment analysis, reward recommendations, and risk detection.

Theme: Starbucks green, brown, cream, and tan color palette for brand consistency.

Features Implemented

Feature	Implementation in the Application
Employee Login	JWT-based login for fixed HRM204 Starbucks demo users with role-based access.
Attendance Tracking	Present, absent, leave, and half-day attendance with check-in/check-out details.
Performance Tracking	Monthly performance reviews using quality, teamwork, communication, punctuality, and overall score.
Reward Points	Performance-linked and recognition-based reward points for employee motivation.
Bonuses	Quarterly bonus eligibility based on attendance, performance, and reward history.
Badges	Achievement badges such as Star Partner, Attendance Champion, Team Builder, and Customer Hero.
Feedback	Employee feedback collection with category, rating, anonymity option, sentiment, and response flow.
AI Insights	Smart recommendations for rewards, bonus eligibility, attendance risk, sentiment, and support watchlist.
Dashboard	One-page view of employee stats, team summary, charts, recommendations, and recent rewards.

Working Process of the Application

The employee logs in using one of the fixed HRM204 Starbucks demo accounts.

The dashboard loads employee profile data, attendance, performance, reward points, bonuses, badges, and feedback insights.

Managers or admins can review employee performance and reward-related information.

The system calculates smart recommendations using performance, attendance, sentiment, bonus, and badge data.

Dashboard charts convert HR data into visual summaries for quick and fair decision-making.

Dashboard Features

The dashboard is the main visual part of the application. It combines employee-level performance information with team-level analytics so that reward decisions can be understood quickly and transparently.

Welcome panel showing employee name, employee ID, department, and role.

Team summary cards showing total employees, average attendance, average performance, and active badges.

Personal statistics cards for reward points, attendance percentage, performance score, and approved bonus.

12 Employee Performance Board showing every Starbucks demo employee with performance and attendance badges.

Smart Reward Recommendations showing suggested reward points and reasons for reward actions.

Support Needed watchlist for employees who may need attendance or performance improvement support.

Reward Points by Category bar chart for performance, attendance, achievement, and special rewards.

Feedback Sentiment pie chart to summarize positive, neutral, and negative feedback patterns.

Feature Execution checklist showing Login/Auth, Attendance, Performance, Reward Points, Bonus, Badges, Feedback, and AI Insights.

Recent Rewards panel showing latest reward reasons, categories, and points.

Top Partners panel ranking high-performing employees.

Dashboard Screenshots

The following screenshots are included as evidence of the dashboard created for the reward system application.

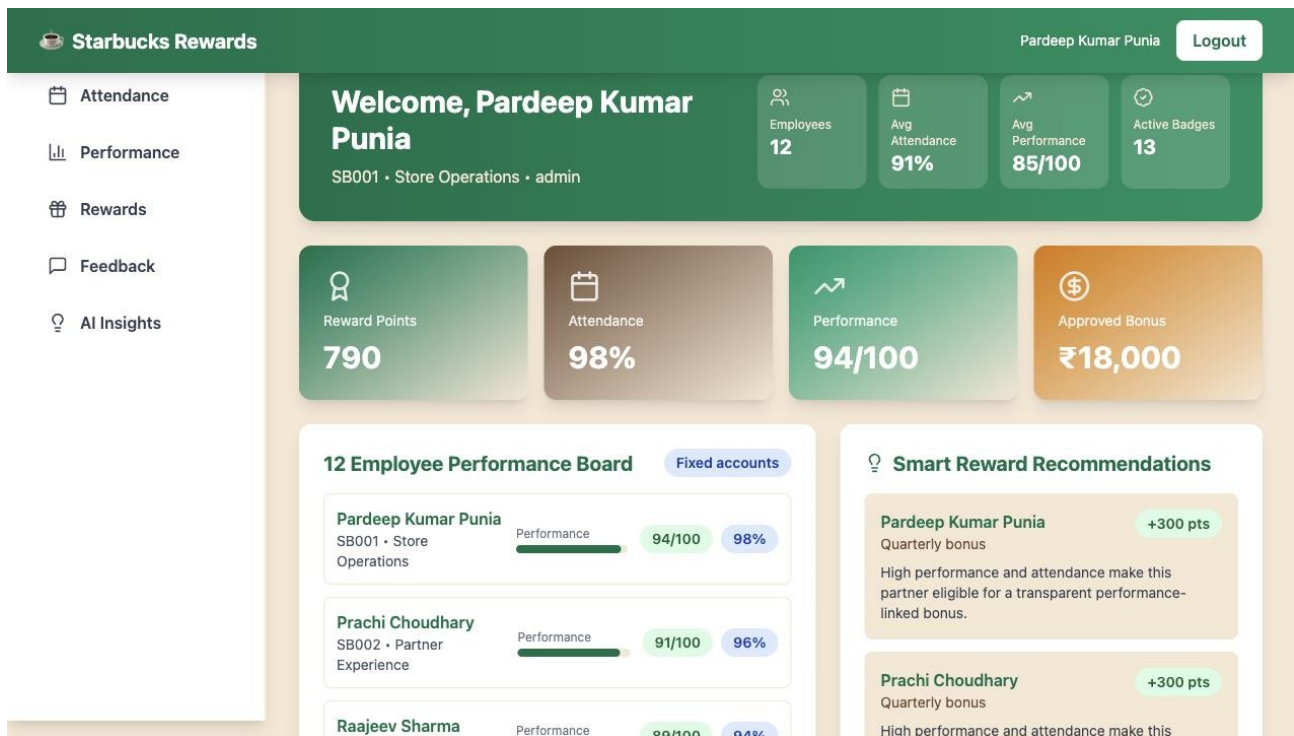


Figure 1: Dashboard overview showing login identity, team summary, personal reward points, attendance, performance, and bonus.

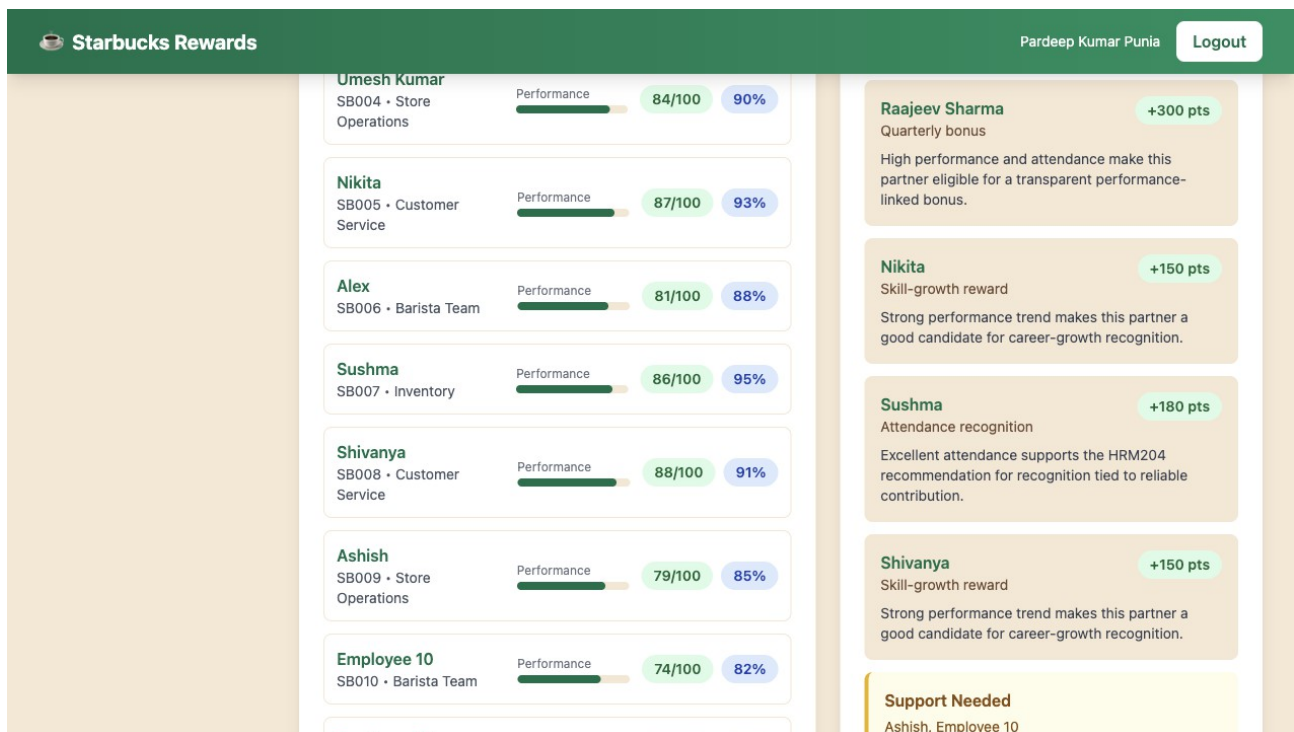


Figure 2: Employee performance board and smart reward recommendations for fair reward decision-making.

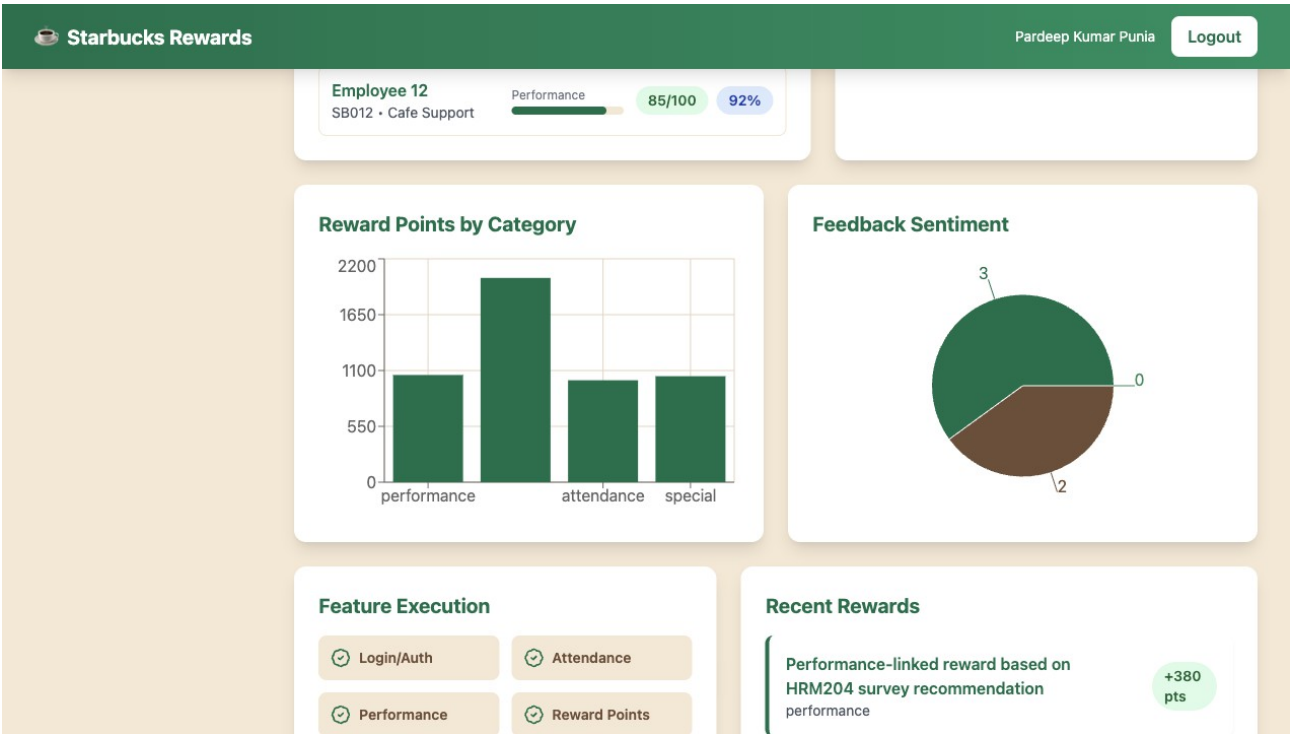


Figure 3: Reward category chart, feedback sentiment chart, feature execution checklist, and recent rewards.

PART 5: AI Integration in Reward System Application

The application includes AI-style decision support to make the reward system more data-driven, fair, and efficient. Instead of giving rewards only through manual judgement, the system analyses employee performance, attendance, feedback, reward history, and badge achievements before recommending suitable actions.

AI/Data-Driven Inputs

Data Input	Role in AI/Data-Driven Reward Decision
Performance score	Used to recommend high performers for bonus/reward recognition.
Attendance percentage	Used to detect reliable employees and identify attendance risk.
Feedback sentiment	Used to understand morale and employee experience patterns.
Reward history	Used to avoid unfair repeated rewards and improve transparency.
Badge achievements	Used as non-financial recognition evidence.
Team averages	Used for dashboard comparison and management decision support.

AI Features Added

Reward recommendation engine to suggest suitable reward points and reasons.

Bonus eligibility analysis for employees with strong performance and attendance.

Attendance risk detection to identify employees who may need support.

Performance trend prediction based on monthly review scores.

Feedback sentiment analysis to understand positive, neutral, and negative employee feedback.

Team-level analytics to compare average attendance, average performance, badges, and reward categories.

AI Tools and Academic Relevance

The CA-II instruction mentions AI tools such as Microsoft Copilot, Power BI, Canva AI, and Python/ML models. In this project, the application uses a local AI reward engine to demonstrate the same academic purpose: data-driven analysis, fair reward recommendations, and clear visual explanation. Microsoft Copilot-style assistance can support idea generation and documentation, Power BI-style dashboarding is represented through charts and analytics, Canva AI can support presentation visuals, and Python/ML concepts can be used for future model-based reward prediction.

Fairness, Transparency, and Privacy

Fairness: Rewards are linked to measurable indicators such as attendance, performance, feedback, and badge evidence.

Transparency: The dashboard gives a reason for each smart reward recommendation.

Efficiency: Managers can review employee data quickly instead of checking multiple manual records.

Privacy: Employee data should be protected through login authentication, limited access, and responsible HR data handling.

Bias control: AI recommendations should support managers, not replace human judgement completely.

PART 6: Presentation Summary of the Reward System Application

For class presentation, the reward system application can be explained through its purpose, major features, working process, AI usage, benefits, challenges, and future improvements.

Purpose of the App

The purpose of the Starbucks Reward System is to create a fair and transparent HRM tool that improves motivation by connecting rewards with attendance, performance, feedback, bonuses, badges, and employee contribution.

Benefits

Improves motivation by making rewards visible and performance-linked.

Supports fair decision-making through data-backed recommendations.

Reduces manual HR work by centralizing employee reward information.

Encourages employees through badges, reward points, recognition, and bonus visibility.

Helps managers identify high performers and employees needing support.

Challenges

Employee data privacy must be maintained carefully.

AI recommendations need transparent logic so employees trust the system.

Accurate data entry is necessary for fair reward decisions.

The system requires regular updates to remain useful for real organizational needs.

Managers must balance AI recommendations with human judgement.

Future Improvements

Add real-time notifications for new rewards, badges, and feedback responses.

Add advanced ML models for reward prediction and employee retention risk.

Add downloadable reports for managers and HR departments.

Add Power BI dashboard integration for deeper analytics.

Add role-specific dashboards for employees, managers, and administrators.

Add stronger security controls such as password reset, audit logs, and multi-factor authentication.

Conclusion

The developed Starbucks Reward System successfully connects the concepts of Compensation Management with a practical digital application. It demonstrates how reward points, bonuses, badges, attendance, performance, feedback, and AI-driven insights can be combined to create a fairer, more motivating, and more transparent employee reward system.